

Λουκιανὸς ὁ Σαμοσατεύς

Lucian of Samosata on Gods, Sophists, and Shams

eul_aid: pfk

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Ἀττικίζουσα [Atticizing](#)
Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)
Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)

Lucian was born in Samosata, the capital of the Roman province of Commagene in northern Syria. A native Syriac speaker who mastered Attic Greek, he abandoned an early apprenticeship in sculpting to become a traveling lecturer and professional rhetorician throughout the Roman Empire. His career peaked during the Second Sophistic, a second-century CE revival of classical Greek culture. Late in life he held an administrative post in Roman Egypt.

His approximately 80 surviving prose works blend satire, dialogue, and parody. Major titles include the parody of travel tales **True History**; the satirical **Dialogues of the Dead** and **Dialogues of the Gods**; **The Sale of Lives**, which auctions off philosophical schools; and polemical exposes like **Alexander the False Prophet**.

Lucian is a central figure of the Second Sophistic, renowned for his Attic style and satirical critique of contemporary intellectual, religious, and social conventions. His inventive dialogues profoundly influenced later European literature, from Erasmus and Shakespeare to the development of satirical and science-fiction narratives.

Works (71)

- Ἀλέξανδρος ἢ Ψευδόμαντις · [Alexander Or The False Prophet](#) · 57 passages
- Ἀνάχαρσις ἢ Περί Γυμνασίων · [Anacharsis Or-Gymnasia](#) · 39 passages
- Ἀπολογία · [Apology](#) · 13 passages
- Θεῶν Ἐκκλησία · [Assembly of the Gods](#) · 18 passages
- Χάρων ἢ Ἐπισκοποῦντες · [Charon or Inspectors](#) · 25 passages
- Ἑταιρικοὶ Διάλογοι · [Companion Dialogues](#) · 60 passages
- Δημώναξ · [Demonax](#) · 38 passages
- Κατάπλους · [Descent to the Underworld](#) · 30 passages
- Διάλογος πρὸς Ἡσίοδον · [Dialogue to Hesiod](#) · 10 passages
- Νεκρικοὶ Διάλογοι · [Dialogues of the Dead](#) · 113 passages
- Θεῶν Διάλογοι · [Dialogues of the Gods](#) · 61 passages
- Κατάπλους ἢ Τύραννος · [Dispute of the Consonants](#) · 12 passages
- Ἠλέκτρον · [Electrum](#) · 7 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον Πατρίδος · [encom of the Fatherland](#) · 12 passages
- Ἐγκώμιον Μύσκης · [encom of the Fly](#) · 12 passages

- Εὐνοῦχος · Eunuch · 13 passages
- Ὑπὲρ τῶν Εἰκόνων · For the Images · 30 passages
- Ὀνειρος ἢ Ἀλεκτρυών · Gallus · 34 passages
- Ποδάγρα · Gout · 43 passages
- Ἀρμονίδης · Harmonides · 5 passages
- Ἡρακλῆς · Hercules · 9 passages
- Ἑρμότιμος ἢ Περὶ Αἰρέσεων · Hermotimus or-Sects · 85 passages
- Ἡρόδοτος ἢ Ἀετίων · Herodotus or Aetion · 8 passages
- Ἱππίας ἢ Βαλανεῖον · Hippias or The Bath · 9 passages
- Πῶς δεῖ Ἱστορίαν συγγράφειν · How to Write History · 58 passages
- Ἰκαρομένιππος ἢ Ὑπερνέφελος · Icaromenippus · 33 passages
- Εἰκόνες · Images · 24 passages
- Ὑπὲρ τοῦ ἐν τῇ Προσαγορεύσει Πταιίσματος · In Defense of the Addressed Fault · 16 passages
- Θεῶν Κρίσις · Judgment of the Gods · 17 passages
- Λεξιφάνης · Lexiphanes · 26 passages
- Μακρόβιοι · Macrobian · 27 passages
- Ἐνάλιοι Διάλογοι · Marine Dialogues · 42 passages
- Μένιππος ἢ Νεκρομαντεία · Menippus or the Necromancy · 22 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Ἀστρολογίας · On Astrology · 25 passages
- Περὶ Ὀρχήσεως · On Dancing · 66 passages
- Περὶ πένθους · On Mourning · 20 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ μὴ ῥαδίως πιστεῦναι Διαβολῇ · On Not Easily Believing Slander · 28 passages
- Περὶ Θυσιῶν · On Sacrifices · 15 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Περεγρίνου Τελευτηῆς · On the Death of Peregrinus · 41 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ Ἐνυπνίου ἥτοι Βίος Λουκιανοῦ · On the Dream or Life of Lucian · 19 passages
- Περὶ Οἴκου · On the House · 24 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ Παρασίτου ὅτι Τέχνη ἢ Παρασιτική · On the Parasite, that Parasite is an Art · 55 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Συρίας Θεοῦ · On the Syrian Goddess · 56 passages
- Περὶ τῶν Διψάδων · On the Thirsty · 10 passages
- Περὶ τῶν ἐν Μισθῷ συνόντων · On Those Living in Misthos · 42 passages
- Φάλαρις · Phalaris · 25 passages
- Φιλοψευδῆς ἢ Ἀπιστῶν · Philopseudes or The Incredulous · 41 passages
- Νιγρίνου Φιλοσοφία · Philosophy of Nigrianus · 37 passages
- Προλαλιά. Διόνυσος · Prologue, Dionysus · 8 passages
- Προμηθεύς · Prometheus · 21 passages
- Ψευδολογιστής · Pseudologist · 33 passages
- Ψευδοσοφιστής ἢ Σολοικιστής · Pseudosophist or Solecist · 13 passages
- Ἀποκηρυττόμενος · Renounced · 32 passages
- Ἀναβιοῦντες ἢ Ἀλιεύς · Reviving or Fisherman · 52 passages
- Δραπέται · Runaways · 32 passages
- Βίων Πράσις · Sale of Lives · 28 passages
- Σκύθης ἢ Πρόξενος · Scythian or the Envoy · 12 passages
- Πλοῖον ἢ Εὐχαί · Ship or Prayers · 46 passages

- Συμπόσιον ἢ Λαπίθαι · Symposium · 46 passages
- Ῥητόρων Διδάσκαλος · Teacher of Rhetoricians · 26 passages
- Τίμων · Timon · 57 passages
- Τὰ πρὸς Κρόνον · To Cronus · 39 passages
- Πρὸς τὸν εἰπόντα Προμηθεὺς εἶ ἐν λόγοις · To the One Who Said, Prometheus If You Are in Words · 8 passages
- Πρὸς τὸν ἀπαίδευτον καὶ πολλὰ βιβλία ὠνούμενον · To the Uneducated Man Buying Many Books · 28 passages
- Τόξαρις ἢ Φιλία · Toxaris or Friendship · 63 passages
- Ἀληθεῖς Ἱστορίαι · True Histories · 89 passages
- Δὺς κατηγορούμενος · Twice Accused · 37 passages
- Τυραννοκτόνος · Tyrannicide · 21 passages
- Ζεὺς ἐλεγχόμενος · Zeus Refuted · 20 passages
- Ζεὺς Τραγωδός · Zeus the Tragedian · 53 passages
- Ζεύξις ἢ Ἀντίοχος · Zeuxis or Antiochus · 13 passages